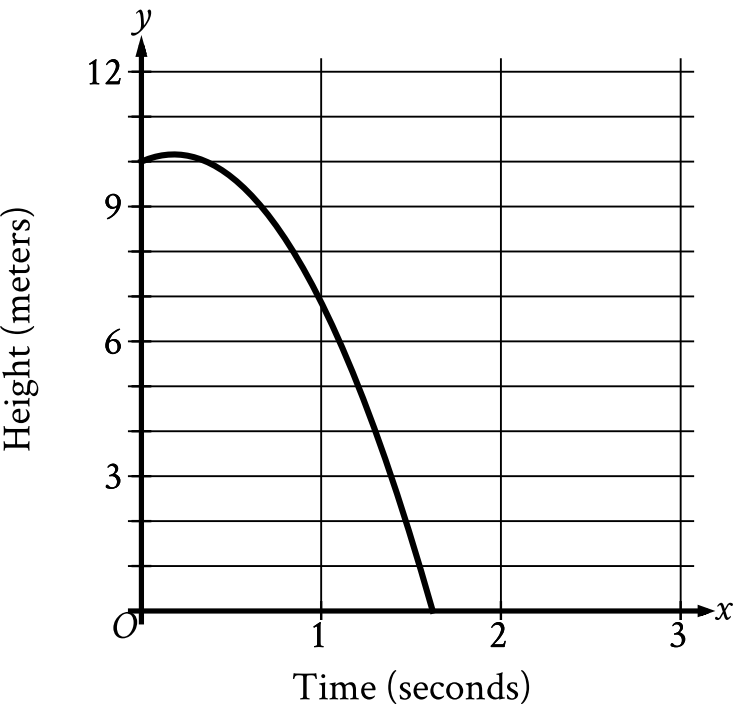


| Assessment | Test | Domain        | Skill               | Difficulty                                          |
|------------|------|---------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| SAT        | Math | Advanced Math | Nonlinear functions | Medium <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |

Question



A competitive diver dives from a platform into the water. The graph shown gives the height above the water  $y$ , in meters, of the diver  $x$  seconds after diving from the platform. What is the best interpretation of the  $x$ -intercept of the graph?

Answer

- A. The diver reaches a maximum height above the water at **1.6** seconds.
- B. The diver hits the water at **1.6** seconds.
- C. The diver reaches a maximum height above the water at **0.2** seconds.
- D. The diver hits the water at **0.2** seconds.

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. It's given that the graph shows the height above the water  $y$ , in meters, of a diver  $x$  seconds after diving from a platform. The  $x$ -intercept of a graph is the point at which the graph intersects the  $x$ -axis, or when the value of  $y$  is  $0$ . The graph shown intersects the  $x$ -axis between  $x = 1$  and  $x = 2$ . In other words, the diver is  $0$  meters above the water, or hits the water, between  $1$  and  $2$  seconds after diving from the platform. Of the given choices, only choice B includes an interpretation where the diver hits the water between  $1$  and  $2$  seconds. Therefore, the best interpretation of the  $x$ -intercept of the graph is the diver hits the water at **1.6** seconds.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice C is incorrect. This is the best interpretation of the maximum value, not the  $x$ -intercept, of the graph.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.